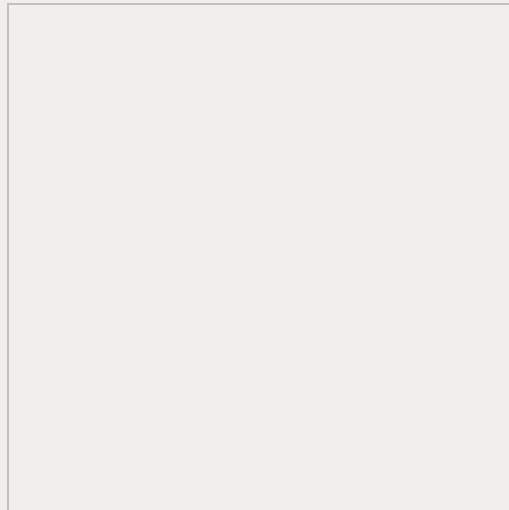


IN CONTEXT

Purcell and Queen Mary

In 1689, the accession of William III and Mary II to the throne marked a crucial point in Purcell's career. While the king was something of a philistine, Queen Mary loved music and was an enthusiastic patron of the arts. For her, Purcell wrote his finest birthday odes, including the colorful "Come, ye sons of art." In March 1695, he also provided the music for Mary's funeral in Westminster Abbey. One of the pieces sung at the burial service, "Thou knowest, Lord, the secrets of our hearts," was performed at Purcell's own funeral later that year.



SILVER MEDAL FOR THE
CORONATION OF WILLIAM AND
MARY, 1689

During his brief yet hectic lifetime, Henry Purcell was acknowledged as unequaled among English composers. After his